

# 10 out of 10 life upgrades for men that cost \$100 or less

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 04, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/2sBzSGCbvRM> Source: full transcript

## Executive Summary

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Brandon Carter shares ten practical, budget-friendly upgrades — mostly under \$100 — covering nutrition tracking, fitness, sleep, productivity, style, and AI tools to help men level up their daily lives.

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## Upgrade 1: Food Scale [0:00](#)

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- A food scale lets you accurately track calories and macros
  - The explicit goal: "finally stop eating fat"
  - Removes guesswork from portion sizes, which is the most common reason diets fail

## Upgrade 2: Walking Shoes [0:00](#)

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- Invest in a good pair of walking shoes to make daily walking sustainable and comfortable
  - Target: **10,000 to 20,000 steps per day**
  - Walking is one of the lowest-barrier, highest-return physical habits

## Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery [0:00](#)

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- Use a meal prep delivery company that sends healthy, ready-to-eat food weekly

- Cost: **\$100–\$300 per week** (technically above the \$100 single-item threshold)
- The value argument: savings in time and money from not cooking and not doing dishes outweigh the expense
- Removes decision fatigue and keeps nutrition on track automatically

## Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate 0:22

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- **Creatine monohydrate** is recommended for everyone, not just people who work out
  - Benefits extend beyond muscle performance — cited as good for brain function and mental health
  - One of the most research-backed, affordable supplements available

## Upgrade 5: Large Water Bottle 0:44

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- Carry a huge water bottle everywhere to hit daily hydration targets
  - Minimum target: **1 gallon of water per day**
  - Brandon personally drinks **2 gallons per day**
  - Having the bottle on you at all times removes friction and serves as a visual reminder

## Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains 0:44

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- Blackout curtains improve sleep quality by eliminating light disruption
  - Rationale: "If you tired, you ain't going to be out here crushing your goals"
  - Sleep is framed as a foundational productivity and performance lever

## Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook 0:44

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- Keep an inexpensive notebook on you at all times
  - Use it to write down ideas as they come and things you need to remember
  - Externalizing thoughts prevents forgetting valuable insights and reduces mental load

## Upgrade 8: AI Subscription (ChatGPT Pro or Claude Max) 1:06

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- Subscribe to **ChatGPT Pro or Claude Max** — specifically the **\$100/month plan**
  - Primary benefit: automation of many recurring tasks, saving significant time
  - Positioned as a high-leverage productivity tool accessible at the \$100 price point

## Upgrade 9: Fitted Black V-Neck T-Shirts 1:06

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- Buy a few packs of fitted black V-neck t-shirts
  - They are versatile — "go with anything"
  - Simple, low-effort way to look consistently put-together



## Upgrade 10: Fitbit to Track Calories and Sleep 1:06

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- A **Fitbit** (specifically called out as "Fitbit Air") is recommended for tracking calories burned and sleep quality
  - Framed as the best budget alternative to a **Whoop** band
  - Ties back to upgrades 1 and 6 — reinforcing the importance of both nutrition tracking and sleep monitoring with data